# Practical 3: Filter RetailPulse Sales by Region and Date

Related topic: Focus Reports Using Filters

## Objective

Apply a simple filter and an advanced detail filter to scope a report to a single region and reporting period, then generalize it with a prompt.

## Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access and the grouped RetailPulse list report from Practical 2.

## Step-by-step procedure

| Step | Action in Cognos Analytics | What you should see |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Open **RetailPulse – Grouped Sales by Region and Store** from My content (Edit mode). | The Practical 2 design opens unchanged. |
| 2 | Select the list, open the **Filters** pane, click **Add**, choose **Region**, set **Equal to** and pick **North**. | A filter “Region equal to North” is listed (simple filter). |
| 3 | Choose **Advanced > Detail filter** and enter: `[Sales Date] between 2026-10-01 and 2026-12-31` | A second filter for the current quarter (Q4 2026) is listed. |
| 4 | Set **Combine filters** to **All filters (AND)**. | Both conditions apply together; the expression joins them with AND. |
| 5 | Click **Run** and compare the row count with Practical 2. | Detail rows fall from 60 to 15; only North stores appear. |
| 6 | Open the Region filter and tick **Prompt every time the report runs** (parameter *pRegion*); save the report. | Cognos creates a prompt page with a Region value prompt; re-running with South returns South rows. |

## Sample solution




Figure 1. Filters pane with the simple and advanced detail filters combined with AND.

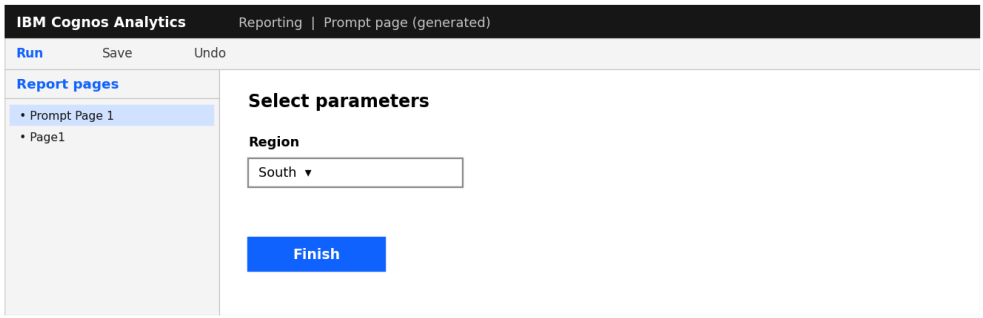



Figure 2. Generated prompt page after converting the Region filter into a prompt (South selected).

### Run 1 – Region = North, Q4 2026 (2026-10-01 to 2026-12-31)

| Region | Store Name | Product Category | Quantity | Sales Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| North | Highland Park | Apparel | 138 | $6,649.05 |
| | | Electronics | 74 | $10,718.34 |
| | | Grocery | 417 | $5,853.15 |
| | | Home & Kitchen | 98 | $6,129.02 |
| | | Sports & Outdoors | 80 | $5,782.26 |
| | | **Total – Highland Park** | **807** | **$35,131.82** |
| | North Plaza | Apparel | 137 | $6,455.51 |
| | | Electronics | 57 | $8,259.53 |
| | | Grocery | 362 | $5,048.20 |
| | | Home & Kitchen | 87 | $5,415.66 |
| | | Sports & Outdoors | 68 | $4,888.95 |
| | | **Total – North Plaza** | **711** | **$30,067.85** |
| | Northgate Mall | Apparel | 103 | $4,866.24 |
| | | Electronics | 48 | $7,037.68 |
| | | Grocery | 295 | $4,052.81 |
| | | Home & Kitchen | 70 | $4,273.89 |
| | | Sports & Outdoors | 59 | $4,280.86 |
| | | **Total – Northgate Mall** | **575** | **$24,511.48** |
| | **Total – North region** | | **2,093** | **$89,711.15** |
| **Total – All regions** | | | **2,093** | **$89,711.15** |

### Run 2 – Region = South (prompted), Q4 2026

| Region | Store Name | Product Category | Quantity | Sales Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| South | Bayview | Apparel | 178 | $8,581.73 |
| | | Electronics | 67 | $9,768.95 |
| | | Grocery | 505 | $7,036.42 |
| | | Home & Kitchen | 128 | $7,959.52 |
| | | Sports & Outdoors | 99 | $7,109.18 |
| | | **Total – Bayview** | **977** | **$40,455.80** |
| | Riverside | Apparel | 161 | $7,794.86 |
| | | Electronics | 61 | $8,862.51 |
| | | Grocery | 396 | $5,572.03 |
| | | Home & Kitchen | 95 | $5,890.26 |
| | | Sports & Outdoors | 81 | $5,823.20 |
| | | **Total – Riverside** | **794** | **$33,942.86** |
| | Southpoint | Apparel | 129 | $6,188.23 |
| | | Electronics | 34 | $4,794.30 |
| | | Grocery | 346 | $4,834.97 |
| | | Home & Kitchen | 87 | $5,374.44 |
| | | Sports & Outdoors | 69 | $4,926.63 |
| | | **Total – Southpoint** | **665** | **$26,118.57** |
| | **Total – South region** | | **2,436** | **$100,517.23** |
| **Total – All regions** | | | **2,436** | **$100,517.23** |

## Verification against the expected outcome

| Measure | Unfiltered (Practical 2) | Filtered: North, Q4 2026 | Prompt re-run: South, Q4 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Detail rows (Region x Store x Category) | 60 | 15 | 15 |
| Total Quantity | 105,638 | 2,093 | 2,436 |
| Total Sales Amount | $4,521,086.88 | $89,711.15 | $100,517.23 |

| Expected outcome check | Result |
|---|---|
| Only rows matching both filters remain | **Pass** – North stores only, dates within 1 Oct–31 Dec 2026 |
| Advanced filter joins the date range with AND | **Pass** – Combine = All filters (AND) |
| Row count visibly smaller than unfiltered | **Pass** – 60 → 15 detail rows |
| Prompted version returns another region | **Pass** – South rows returned when the prompt value changes |

Note on screens: the screenshots in this document are Cognos-style renderings produced from a synthetic RetailPulse dataset (12 stores, 4 regions, 5 product categories, 1 Jan–25 Oct 2026). Replace them with live captures from your own Cognos environment if your submission requires real screenshots.